Department Rules, Laboratory Safety and Mini-Project Guidelines

Institution: College of Engineering & Technology | **Official Policy Document**

1. Laboratory Attendance and Conduct

Students must attend 100% of all scheduled laboratory practicals. If a laboratory session is missed due to verified medical illness, the student must attend the designated Saturday makeup laboratory session within 10 days. Laboratory observation notebooks and completed experiment records must be verified and signed by the faculty-in-charge in the very next lab session.

2. Laboratory Safety Precautions

Safety is the highest priority in departmental laboratories. Wearing closed-toe shoes and cotton lab coats is mandatory in electrical, mechanical, and hardware laboratories. Consuming food, beverages, or water near computer terminals is strictly prohibited. Connecting unverified personal external flash drives to laboratory systems is forbidden to prevent malware contamination.

3. Mini-Project Guidelines and Milestone Schedule

The final-year mini project carries 2 credits and must be executed in teams of 3 to 4 students. Project milestones must strictly be adhered to: Milestone 1 (Week 4): Project abstract, problem definition, and Jira setup approval; Milestone 2 (Week 8): Mid-semester progress demo, RAG pipeline and vector store implementation; Milestone 3 (Week 14): Final working demonstration, Streamlit UI, evaluation report, and documentation submission.

4. Mini-Project Evaluation Rubric

The 100-mark mini-project evaluation is broken down as follows: (a) Problem Definition and Functional Requirements: 15 marks; (b) System Architecture and RAG Implementation: 30 marks; (c) Jira Project Management and Sprint Tracking: 20 marks; (d) Functional Testing, Retrieval Evaluation and Hallucination Assessment: 15 marks; (e) Final Presentation, Viva Voce and Demonstration: 20 marks.

5. Plagiarism and Academic Integrity Policy

All project reports, documentation, and technical code submissions will be scanned using institutional plagiarism detection software. The report must have an overall similarity index of less than 15%, excluding code snippets and bibliography references. Submissions with plagiarism exceeding 25% will be summarily rejected and the team must re-register for the course.